Ford Motor Company

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs
Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

May 2000

**TO:** All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

**SUBJECT:** **Owner Notification Program 00B45:** Certain 2000 Model Year Lincoln LS Vehicles Located in the U.S., U.S. Territories, Mexico and Canada

**REFERENCES:**
1.) Dealer Announcement dated 12/17/98, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment IV)
2.) Emissions Recall 00E08 dated 5/00, Lincoln LS – Fuel Delivery Module

**NOTE:** Vehicles affected by ONP 00B45 may also be included in Emissions Recall 00E08 and Owner Notification Program 00B39. To minimize customer inconvenience and to effectively use the Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Allowance, please check OASIS and, if applicable, perform Emissions Recall 00E08 and/or ONP 00B39 when the vehicle is in your dealership for ONP 00B45.

| | |
|---|---|
| OASIS : | Yes |
| OWNER LIST: | Will be provided in upcoming Ford Dealership Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). |
| PARTS RETURN: | Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for "Parts Retention and Return Procedures". |
| PROGRAM TERMS: | This program will be in effect until June 30, 2001, regardless of mileage. |

## AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 model year Lincoln LS vehicles without the sport package built at the Wixom Assembly Plant through November 16, 1999.

Certain 2000 model year Lincoln LS vehicles with the sport package built at the Wixom Assembly Plant through December 15, 1999.

Note: Some vehicles in the affected time periods are not affected. Check OASIS to verify vehicle eligibility.

## REASON FOR PROGRAM

Some of the affected vehicles were built with Powertrain Control Module (PCM) calibration strategy features that may cause the vehicle to exhibit one or more of the following engine or transmission symptoms:

- Un-commanded downshift while operating vehicle in select shift mode (Select Shift Transmission (SST) only)
- Harsh engagement
- Harsh or delayed shifts
- Light surging during steady speed driving
- Reduced engine braking during deceleration
- Occasional long crank times when starting the engine
- Occasional hesitation or stumble during tip-in acceleration
- Spark knock during tip-in acceleration

## SERVICE ACTION

The vehicle's PCM must be reprogrammed using the Worldwide Diagnostic System (WDS) or the New Generation Star Tester (NGS).

## LINCOLN COMMITMENT SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all LS owners affected by this program. Please see dealer announcement dated 12/17/98, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment IV). The special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer Lincoln owners convenient vehicle handling.

Lincoln Mercury is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for our LS customers, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

Note: Some vehicles in the affected time periods are not affected. Check OASIS to verify vehicle eligibility.

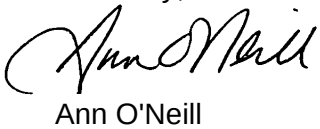
## ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Attachment IV: Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure Announcement Letter
Customer Notification Letter

## QUESTIONS?

Claims Information: 1-800-423-8851
Other Program Questions: 1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director

Vehicle Service and Programs

**OWNER NOTIFICATION PROGRAM 00B45**
Certain 2000 Model Year Lincoln LS Vehicles Located in the U.S.,
U.S. Territories, Mexico and Canada – PCM Reprogram

## OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this program.

## PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery.

## PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on the VIN list provided in the Ford Dealership Consolidated Communicator (FDCC) and other eligible vehicles, which are brought to your dealership.

## DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give owner a copy of the Owner Letter. Arrange with the owner for a service date.

Note: LS owners should receive the "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure". Before calling LS owners, review Attachment IV to familiarize yourself with this special handling procedure.

Note: Some vehicles in the affected time periods are not affected. Check OASIS to verify vehicle eligibility.

## CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII Manual for claims preparation and submission information.
- To claim for the "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling" on LS vehicles, follow the instructions on page two of Attachment IV.

## RENTAL CARS

As part of the Lincoln Commitment Special Handling procedure, Ford will pay for a loaner or rental vehicle except for fuel, which will be at the owner's expense. Rentals should be provided only while the vehicle is at the dealership for PCM reprogramming (and if the vehicle is also affected by Emissions Recall 00E08 and/or ONP 00B39).

Note: Before calling LS owners, review Attachment IV to familiarize yourself with the Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure.

## PARTS RETENTION

Follow the provisions of the Warranty and Policy Manual for "Parts Retention and Return Procedures".

**OWNER NOTIFICATION PROGRAM 00B45**
Certain 2000 Model Year Lincoln LS Vehicles Located in the U.S.,
U.S. Territories, Mexico and Canada – PCM Reprogram

## LABOR ALLOWANCES

| Description | Labor Operation | Labor Time |
|---|---|---|
| Unable to Reprogram Powertrain Control Module Calibration Level (Latest Level Already Installed) | 00B45A | 0.3 Hours |
| Reprogram Powertrain Control Module and Affix Modification Label | 00B45B | 0.4 Hours |
| Lincoln Commitment Special Handling * | Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" | See Attachment IV |

* Lincoln Commitment Special Handling does not apply to vehicles in dealer stock.

## PARTS REQUIREMENTS

| Part Number | Quantity | Description |
|---|---|---|
| FPS-8262 | 1 | Authorized Modifications Label (Free to Dealers) |

# Program Announcement Letter
# Lincoln Commitment Special Handling

Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P.O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

December 17, 1998

To: All Lincoln Mercury and Ford Dealers

cc: Parts Managers
Service Managers

Subject: Announcing Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure for Certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs

As part of our ongoing commitment to Lincoln customers, we are pleased to announce the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure to provide additional dealer compensation for certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs(ONP's) that affect Lincoln brand vehicles.

This additional compensation is being provided to allow dealers to provide personalized service designed to make the recall repair a positive experience for the Lincoln customer, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

Each Recall/ONP Bulletin affecting Lincoln vehicles will indicate whether the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure is authorized; please note that not every Recall/ONP will qualify for this procedure and that the procedure will not be communicated to customers as a normal benefit of the Lincoln Commitment Program. Special handling and claiming instructions are included on the attached page. This program will apply only to Lincoln vehicles which have been delivered to customers (This Special Customer Handling does not apply to vehicles in stock or in daily rental fleets).

We ask you to make maximum usage of these special enhancements to the Lincoln Commitment Program when applicable. Thank you in advance for your support of this program and our commitment to surprise and delight our Lincoln customers.

/O.S.B./
Mark Hutchins
President
Lincoln Mercury

/O.S.B./
M. D. Jordan
Executive Director
Ford Customer Service Division
North America

## Lincoln Commitment Special Handling

(NOTE: Special Customer Handling does not apply to vehicles in stock or in daily rental fleets).

### If Dealer Picks up and Returns Vehicle for Customer:

| Special Service | Dealer Compensation | Claim Procedure |
|---|---|---|
| • Pick up the customer's vehicle (at a location of their preference such as home or place of business) and return after repair*<br>• Drop off comparable loaner vehicle<br>• Refill fuel tank<br>• Wash and vacuum vehicle<br>• Return vehicle to customer after repair is completed | Up to 2 hours additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum<br>Note: Labor time to fill tank and wash/vacuum has been included in 2 hour allowance<br>Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual | Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"<br><br>EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $58/hour and fuel cost of $1.05/gallon):<br>1.2 hrs. labor* = $69.60<br>9.0 gals fuel = 9.45<br>Wash/vacuum = 3.50<br>Total Submitted = $82.55<br>*Travel time plus fueling and washing labor. |
| Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer when vehicle is picked up | Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $18 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation) | Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization) |
| Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership | Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin | See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin |

*Or repair on-site if appropriate; if on-site repair is performed, rental charges do not apply.

### If Customer Brings Vehicle to Dealer:

| Special Service | Dealer Compensation | Claim Procedure |
|---|---|---|
| Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership | Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin | See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin |
| Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer | Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $18 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner<br>(This does not count against TAP allocation) | Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization) |
| Refill fuel tank and wash/ vacuum vehicle | Up to 0.5 hour additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) | Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum | using Misc. Expense Code “LCHP” |

LINCOLN

Lincoln Mercury
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-521-4140
www.ownerconnection.com

June 2000

00B45
**(Kit AA, Kit AA Federalized, Kit BB, and Kit BB Federalized from 00B45)**

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

We hope you are enjoying your Lincoln LS vehicle, which was recently named "2000 Motor Trend Car of the Year". To further improve your driving experience, we'd like to offer you the opportunity to upgrade your vehicle. Therefore, we are providing the following no-charge service, Program Number 00B45, to owners of certain 2000 model year Lincoln LS vehicles.

**Reason For This Program**

Some of the affected vehicles were built with Powertrain Control Module (PCM) calibration strategy features that may cause the vehicle to exhibit one or more of the following engine or transmission symptoms:

- Un-commanded downshift while operating vehicle in select shift mode (Select Shift Transmission (SST) only)
- Harsh engagement
- Harsh or delayed shifts
- Light surging during steady speed driving
- Reduced engine braking during deceleration
- Occasional long crank times when starting the engine
- Occasional hesitation or stumble during acceleration
- Spark knock during acceleration

**What Lincoln and your Lincoln dealer will do…**

At no charge to you, your dealer will check your vehicle's PCM calibration and reprogram the PCM, if necessary.

This program will be in effect until June 30, 2001, regardless of mileage.

**What we are asking you to do…**

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date for Owner Notification Program 00B45.

**How long will it take….**

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling requirements, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

**If you need a loaner vehicle…**

Your dealer is authorized to provide a free loaner vehicle (except for fuel) while your vehicle is at the dealership for the PCM reprogramming.

**If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…**

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

**If you have concerns…**

If you have concerns, please call the Lincoln Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 521-4140
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

**Office Hours: 8am - 11pm (Monday-Friday) ET**
**9am - 6pm (Saturday) ET**.

You may also contact us through the internet at www.ownerconnection.com. Our current response time to internet inquiries is approximately three business days.

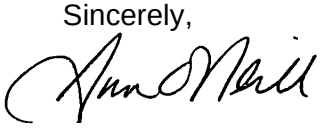
**Quality Care service is there for you all year round.**

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our Lincoln dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

Lincoln is conducting this action as part of our ongoing efforts to exceed owner expectations and maintain consumer confidence in our products. We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention in this important matter. And once again, we thank you for choosing the Lincoln LS.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director

Vehicle Service and Programs